

Definition of Done (DoD)

What is Definition of Done (DoD)?

The Definition of Done is an officially agreed-upon set of criteria that must be completely satisfied before a user story, feature, or project increment can be considered complete. It establishes an uncompromised benchmark for release quality.

Core Characteristics

- ✓ Constructed as a short, measurable, and highly transparent checklist.
- ✓ Ensures zero pending or leftover work remains at iteration boundaries.
- ✓ Explicitly dictates exactly how stable and shippable the final product must be.

Shared Accountability

Who collectively determines and shapes the Definition of Done standard?

- ✓ **Scrum Team:** Collaborates to implement and adhere to standards.
- ✓ **Product Owner:** Validates alignment with shippable product criteria.
- ✓ **Scrum Master:** Facilitates standard definition and guides adherence.

WHAT THE DOD UNCOVERS & SAFEGUARDS

A rigorous DoD creates organizational transparency across three critical structural dimensions:

- ✓ **Value Creation Transparency:** Provides full visibility into all developmental steps, testing tiers, and validation checks required to create true user value in the form of a Product Increment.
- ✓ **State Assessment Transparency:** Highlights the precise current capabilities of the engineering pipeline, surfacing gaps between unpolished increments and fully realized customer value.
- ✓ **Continuous Improvement Transparency:** Exposes systemic optimization points and technical gaps, allowing the team to iteratively elevate their quality standard over successive sprints.

Why the DoD is Mandatory

- 1 **Inspect & Adapt:** Enables constant empirical inspection and adaptive course-correction over the evolving Product Increment.
- 2 **Shared Understanding:** Drives absolute transparency and mutual alignment on the qualitative state of the deliverables.
- 3 **Risk Management:** Actively mitigates and manages the volatile operational risks of carrying "Undone" work down the timeline.

Enterprise Sample DoD List

- ✓ Peer Code Review successfully completed & approved
- ✓ Unit test suite executed with passing thresholds
- ✓ Acceptance Testing & SIT validation complete
- ✓ Product Owner review finalized and officially signed off
- ✓ Zero critical, high, or blocking open bugs remaining
- ✓ Artifact package deployed into UAT environment
- ✓ Production deployment pipeline validation finalized
- ✓ Story status formally verified and closed

STRATEGIC OPERATIONAL BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ **Frequently Revisit the Criteria:** The DoD list is a living document. Review and update it routinely during Retrospectives as the engineering maturity of the group increases.
- ✓ **Benchmark Future Target States:** Ensure the definition continuously emerges and matures over time by establishing clear engineering benchmarks.
- ✓ **Embed Directly in Workflow Statuses:** Reinforce compliance by explicitly mapping the DoD parameters directly into your team's ALM/task tracking system columns or workflow validation gates.
- ✓ **Maintain a Single Unified Standard:** If multiple Scrum teams are co-developing a unified product or component backlog, they must maintain and honor a single, shared Definition of Done for that Product Increment.
- ✓ **Incorporate Non-Functional Requirements (NFRs):** Systematically integrate performance limits, security benchmarks, data compliance constraints, and architectural standards as permanent anchors inside your core DoD checklist.